ICU Team Update

November 2026 | Critical Care, Midland Metropolitan University Hospital

Key headlines only. Full detail, links, images and audio: see the online newsletter.

RESEARCH CORNER

SHORTER Trial: second nationally

Our Trust ranked 2nd nationally for recruitment, one participant behind UHB. Thank you to everyone who screens.

September figures

42 patients screened, 18 recruited.

eFONAr airway registry

Tell Bharati, Wasim or Preksha about any eFONA case: attempted or performed, any age. Do not enter non-emergency front-of-neck access.

Research Hub

QR stickers are now on the ward computers for quick eligibility checks. swb-icu.github.io/research

TEAM NEWS

Welcome, six new Band 5 nurses

Katie Hazlehurst, Shanice Carty, Lauren Bray, Vanessa Baxter, Talar Dana and Millie Field.

AHP awards (14 October)

The ICU therapy team won the AHP Prevention award, and Liz Evans (ICU therapy lead) won AHP of the Year.

CLINICAL UPDATES

Cath Lab EMRT calls

The ICU registrar now attends all Cath Lab EMRT calls with the standard team. Bleeps 6139 and 5947. No change for other areas.

Winter swabs

Swab everyone admitted with respiratory symptoms (COVID, influenza and RSV PCR on Unity, purple bags). Isolate until the result is available.

Biopsy forceps on the airway trolley

In the Plan A section of the ICU Difficult Airway Trolley for central airway obstruction. They fit through the Ambuscope and are not on other Trust trolleys.

TRAINING & STANDARDS

PPE for intubation

Infectious status is often unknown. You may choose FFP3 and a visor.

Uniform and appearance

ICU uniform on duty only. Yellow badge visible so your role is clear. Bare below the elbows, no lanyards. Lead by example, and it is fine to ask.

Mandatory training

Check yours is current and complete anything that has lapsed.

SAFETY & QUALITY

Before extubation

Review cumulative fluid balance and volume status.

High-risk LMWH

Document the risk-benefit assessment. Agree drug, dose and monitoring with the MDT. Anti-Xa guidance is coming from Haematology.

Before transfer

Confirm the discharge or transfer note is complete.

Out of hours

Highlight goals at handover. Escalate and document if plans are off track.

Families

Offer hope alongside honest expectations.

NMP lead

Janine is NMP lead again. Watch for her audit, declaration and survey emails.

Midnight Law

Mental Capacity Act and DoLS: ficm.ac.uk/midnightlaws

OPERATIONAL & LOOKING AHEAD

Family room

For relatives only. Access via the shift coordinator or admin. Return keys to ICU, not the Welcome Centre.

L5 outdoor space

SOP approved by the Trust Exec team. Roll-out to follow.

Local anaesthetic infusions

New Unity prescriptions: ropivacaine 400mg/200ml and levobupivacaine 250mg/200ml (bupivacaine shortage). Stocked in zone 1 and 3 Omnicells.

Diary

Mon 7 Dec: Christmas Forum, Education Centre, Sandwell. Sat 19 Dec: ITU Christmas Party.